

## » SPORTSTAR ACES AWARDS WHAT THE JURY MEMBERS SAY



SCAN FOR  
MORE

2024 was a heartening year for sports in India. A World Cup win in cricket, medals galore at the Olympics and Paralympics and the emergence of a new generation of stars in the sporting world have made the year a memorable one. On the sidelines of the seventh annual **Sportstar Aces Awards**, members of the jury look back at their takeaways from 2024 and the happy headache of harder decision-making meetings as the years go by.



**Sunil Gavaskar:** Mainstream sports is no longer just about cricket and much credit for that goes to magazines and newspapers like Sportstar and The Hindu which are now covering more disciplines. There was a time when sports page real estate across newspapers was taken up mostly by cricket. It didn't have to be national cricket or international cricket; there was a lot of local club cricket which was covered at the expense of other international events which were happening in different sports. That's not the case now. The television medium has made a difference towards that end too, because now a lot of people who probably wouldn't have seen other sports are able to now see what other sports are, see what their demands and difficulties are and enjoy them.

**MM Somaya:** The discussions this time were so intense and it was hard to differentiate between nominees at several stages. I can't believe it but in a couple of categories, I didn't even initially recommend a hockey player. I was so fortunate that the others supported the nominees and eventually some of the very critical awards feature members from my sport.

I think that's the nature of the jury. We are very open in our decision-making process and are open to our decisions being overruled as well, if need be. When considerations get very close, the temperament of the person, consistency at the highest level, performance under pressure and how competitive their sport is have all been considered by the jury this year.

